

Marvin Morgan

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Education

University of California, Santa Barbara

Candidate for Doctorate of Philosophy in Physics & Astrophysics

Santa Barbara, CA

Graduation: Spring 2027

University of Texas at Austin

Master of Science in Astronomy & Astrophysics

Austin, TX

Graduation: December 2023

University of Pennsylvania

Master of Science in Physics & Astronomy

Bachelors of Arts in Physics & Astrophysics

Philadelphia, PA

Graduation: May 2021

Graduation: May 2021

Honors & Awards

Graduate:

McDonald Observatory Teten Excellence Fellowship Recipient

2025

Frank N. Edmonds, Jr. Memorial Fellowship Award Recipient

2024-2025

College of Natural Sciences Graduate Continuing Fellowship

2023-2024

College of Natural Sciences Mentoring Dean's Strategic Fellowship

2021- 2023

Undergraduate:

Prestigious Roy and Diana Vagelos Science Challenge Award

2020-2021

Relevant Experience

Teaching Assistant

Austin, TX

Fall 2024: Astronomy 307 Introduction to Astronomy for Majors

Teaching Assistant

Philadelphia, PA

Spring 2021: Physics 102 General Physics: Electromagnetism, Optics, and Modern Physics

Service, Leadership, & Outreach

Gaia DR4 Pre-Vetting Substellar Survey Collaboration (17 nights, Lick & Keck)

2025-Present

California Planet Search Team (3 nights, Keck)

2026-Present

Habitable Worlds Observatory Pre-Vetting (4 Nights, Keck)

2025-2026

Graduate-Undergrad Mentorship in astronomy (GUMMY) Research Mentor

2022-2025

The National Society of Black Physicists UT Austin Recruiter:

2023-2025

University of Texas Division I Track and Field Athlete:

2021-2022

UPenn Division I Track and Field Captain & Record holder:

2018-2021

Grants

James Webb Space Telescope, NASA/STScI

\$142K (PI) Imaging a Hidden Super-Jupiter Accelerating its Metal-rich M-dwarf Host

Cycle 4 GO

Selected PI/Co-PI Observing Proposals

JWST Cycle 4 GO 9091, PI Morgan, Imaging a Hidden Super-Jupiter Accelerating its Metal-rich M-dwarf Host, 16.1 hours awarded

ESO / VLTI-GRAVITY (ATs), PI Morgan, Probing the Influence of Distant Binary Companions on Long-Period Giant Planets, 9 hr awarded, equivalent to 4 nights, (FTC 117, 2026)

ESO / VLTI-GRAVITY (UTs), Co-PI Morgan, Constraining Migration Pathways of Hot Jupiters in Stellar Binaries with Precise Binary Orbits, 13.5 hr awarded, equivalent to 6 nights, (P117, 2025)

ESO / VLTI-GRAVITY (ATs), Co-PI Morgan, Constraining Migration Pathways of Hot Jupiters in Stellar Binaries with Precise Binary Orbits, 4.5 hr awarded, equivalent to 2 nights, (P117, 2025)

Keck / NIRC2, Co-PI Morgan, Constraining Migration Pathways of Hot Jupiters in Stellar Binaries with Precise Binary Orbits, 5 nights awarded through UCO Access (2026A, 2026B)

HET / HPF, PI Morgan, Testing the Origin of Warm Jupiters with Population-Level Eccentricities, 82 hours awarded through UT Access (T22-1, T22-2, T22-3, T23-1)

MINERVA-Australis, PI Morgan, 225 hours awarded through NOIRLab / NN-EXPLORE program (2022A, 2022B, 2023A)

JWST Cycle 3 GO 6139, PI Bowler, Angular Momentum Architecture of the HR 8799 Planetary System, Co-I, 23.16 hours awarded

First Authored Publications (5)

(1) Evidence for an Outer Giant Planet or Brown Dwarf in the 51 Pegasi System

Morgan, M., Bowler, B. P., Franson, K., Jiang, L., et al., 2026, *AJ*, **172**, 60.

(2) Exploring Warm Jupiter Migration Pathways with Eccentricities. II. Correlations with Host Star Properties and Orbital Separation

Morgan, M., Bowler, B. P., Tran, Q. H., et al., 2026, *AJ*, **171**, 19.

(3) Exploring Warm Jupiter Migration Pathways with Eccentricities. I. Catalog of Uniform Keplerian Fits to Radial Velocities of 200 Warm Jupiters

Morgan, M., Bowler, B. P., Tran, Q. H., et al., 2025, *ApJS*, **280**, 76.

(4) Signs of Similar Stellar Obliquity Distributions for Hot and Warm Jupiters Orbiting Cool Stars

Morgan, M., Bowler, B. P., Tran, Q. H., et al., 2024, *AJ*, **167**, 48.

(5) Collisional Growth Within the Solar System's Primordial Disk and Timing of the Giant Planet Instability

Morgan, M., Seligman, D., & Batygin, K., 2021, *ApJL*, **917**, L8.

Contributions (6)

(1) Rotation Periods, Inclinations, and Obliquities of Cool Stars Hosting Directly Imaged Substellar Companions: Spin–Orbit Misalignments Are Common

Bowler B. P., Tran Q. H., Zhoujian Z., **Morgan M.**, et al. 2022, *AJ*, 165, 164B

(2) One-third of Sun-like stars are born with misaligned planet-forming disks

Biddle L.I., Bowler B.P., **Morgan M.**, et al. 2025, *Nature*, 644, 356.

(3) The Optical Photometric Variability of Herbig Ae/Be Stars from TESS

Cody A.~M., Hillenbrand L.~A., Chandragiri S., **Morgan M.**, 2025, *ApJ*, 994, 253.

(4) Gaia Exoplanet Orbits, Demographics, and Evolution Survey (GEODES). I.

Van Zandt J., Bowler B.~P., Petigura E.~A., Franson K., Xuan J.~W., **Morgan M.**, et al., 2026, *ApJ*, 1006, 222.

(5) Potential Melting of Extrasolar Planets by Tidal Dissipation

Seligman, D. Z., et al., 2024, *ApJ*, 961, 22S

(6) Astrometric Accelerations as Dynamical Beacons: Giant Planet Imaged inside the Debris Disk of AF Lep

Franson, K., et al., 2023, *ApJ*, 950L, 19F

Talks & Posters

Conference Posters:

Contributed Talk	On the Shoulders of Giants: Turin, Italy	2026
Contributed Talk	OHP – 51 Pegasi b: Saint-Michel-l'Observatoire, France	2025
Contributed Talk	OWL Conference, Santa Cruz, California	2025
Contributed Talk	Exoplanets 5 Leiden Netherlands	2024
Contributed Talk	ERES VIII Yale University	2023
Seminar Talk	University of Hawaii IfA, SPLAT seminar	2026
Seminar Talk	University of California, Santa Cruz PLUNCH seminar	2026
Seminar Talk	University of Michigan SPF Seminar	2026
Seminar Talk	Michigan State University Astronomy Seminar	2026
Poster	Extreme Solar Systems V Christchurch, New Zealand	2024
Poster	9th GMT COMMUNITY SCIENCE MEETING	2023
Poster	National Society of Black Physicists Conference	2020
Contributed Talk	AAS Division on Dynamical Astronomy Meeting #51	2020

Media Links/ Appearances

University of Pennsylvania Pathways Interview

Record Breaking Track Performance

University of Pennsylvania Daily Pennsylvanian Interview

Stellar Flyby's Research Article